

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

MAY 2026

Evaluator Name: **John Kendric P. Pahoyo**

Project Title: **WonderPets**

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Heuristic	Issue /s	Recommendations
1. Visibility of system status The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time. Does the design clearly communicate its state? Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?	N/A	N/A
2. Match between system and the real world The system should speak the users' language, with words, phrases and concepts familiar to the user, rather than system-oriented terms. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order. Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design? Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?	N/A	N/A

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3. User control and freedom Users often choose system functions by mistake and will need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted state without having to go through an extended dialogue. Support undo and redo. Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process? Are exit links easily discoverable? Can users easily cancel an action? Is Undo and Redo supported?	Some buttons are not well visible, especially back, cancel, and edit buttons	Provide a well highlighted design
4. Consistency and standards Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Does the design follow industry conventions? Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?	There are certain buttons and layouts that differ somewhat between pages.	Some buttons and layouts are a little different on different sites.
5. Error prevention	Users may unintentionally leave crucial information blank because	Before submitting, display real-time validation alerts and add

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Even better than good error messages are a careful design which prevents a problem from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action. Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints? Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?	required fields are not clearly defined.	asterisks (*) for mandatory fields.
6. Recognition rather than recall Minimize the user's memory load by making objects, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the dialogue to another. Instructions for use of the system should be visible or easily retrievable whenever appropriat. Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it? Does the design offer help in-context?	N/A	N/A

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7. Flexibility and efficiency of use Accelerators—unseen by the novice user—may often speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the system can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions. Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures? Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?	N/A	N/A
8. Aesthetic and minimalist design Dialogues should not contain information which is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in a dialogue competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility. Is the visual design and content focused on the	N/A	N/A

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essentials? Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?		
9. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution. Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text? Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?	Messages on error management and recovery are not readily apparent.	Provide concise error messages along with advice on how users can resolve issues right away.
10. Help and documentation Even though it is better if the system can be used without documentation, it may be necessary to provide help and documentation. Any such information should be easy to search, focused on the user's task, list concrete steps to be carried out, and not be too large.	There was no user manual, FAQ, or help center displayed in the system.	For simpler navigation and assistance, include user manuals, tooltips, and FAQs.

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Is help documentation easy to search? Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?		